



Management Performance:

Lue 04 Biodiversity Management Plan



Credits

No Minimum Standard

Aim

To encourage organisations to develop, implement and keep under review a biodiversity action plan based on the outcomes of the ecology survey, which sets targets to maintain and enhance the ecological value of the site.

Question

Is there a biodiversity management plan in place which aligns with local and regional biodiversity action plans and sets specific targets to enhance the ecological value of the site?

Credits	Answer	Select one answer A-D, select answer E if applicable
0	A.	Question not answered
0	B.	No
2	C.	Yes, plans have been put in place to manage and maintain existing ecological features, which align with local or regional biodiversity action plans
4	D.	Yes, an action plan has been put in place to ensure continued improvement to the ecological value and biodiversity of the site in line with local guidance.
2	E.	The Management plan has been informed by recommendations made by a Suitably Qualified Ecologist (SQE) and meets the guidance set out in the National / Regional Biodiversity action plans.

Assessment criteria

Criterion	Assessment criteria	Applicable Answer
1.	A Biodiversity management plan should set targets that are: a) Specific to the asset/site b) Measurable and achievable c) Realistic and time bound	C, D

Criterion	Assessment criteria	Applicable Answer
2.	The management plan should be informed by the local biodiversity strategies and action plans. If credits have been awarded for Lue 03 Ecology report the management plan should also take into consideration these findings and the recommendations made by the SQE. If there are no ecological features on the site and credits were achieved in Lue 03 Ecology report for enhancing the local area off-site, the biodiversity management plan must apply to the same area used to gain these credits.	C, D
3.	The management plan should be reviewed and updated every 3 years or earlier if there are significant changes to the asset's footprint or the ecological features on-site.	C, D
4.	Organisations responsible for the site's landscape management should either, a) Have their own policies that stipulate that the work they undertake will maintain or enhance (if getting extra credit for this) the ecological value on-site in line with the biodiversity management plan. OR b) Have contractual agreements with building management or building owner that stipulate that the work they undertake will maintain or enhance the ecological value on-site in line with the biodiversity management plan. Progress should be reviewed to ensure ecological value is being maintained or enhanced as appropriate. Where it is not, management plans need to be updated.	C, D
5.	The management plan should cover (but is not limited to): a) Landscaping b) Integrated pest management c) Cleaning of façade, landscaping and hardscaping d) Planting/installation of features to enhance flora and fauna on-site e) Clearly defined and allocated roles and responsibilities.	C, D
6.	The management plan for the asset should link to local and regional biodiversity requirements as well as the local biodiversity action plan (BAP), in accordance with the Convention on Biological Diversity where applicable.	C

Evidence

Criteria	Evidence requirement
-	The evidence below is not exhaustive, please also refer to the 'BREEAM evidential requirements' section in the scope of the Guidance for appropriate evidence types which can be used to demonstrate compliance.
All	Copy of biodiversity plan /strategy
2, 3	Evidence that the plan/strategy was developed by a competent individual such as copies of relevant documents, qualifications, CV or industry membership.

Definitions

Biodiversity action plan (BAP):

An international programme brought about at the convention on biological diversity in 1992. The programme encourages nations to develop and adopt a strategy which will protect and restore biological systems around the world by addressing threats to native species and habitats in any given area. The action plans should include four major steps:

- A survey of all species and habitats located within the area relating to the BAP.
- An assessment of the conservation status of all the species and habitats
- Targets for the conservation and creation of the biodiversity within the given area
- An established budget, timeline and partnership where necessary for implementing the enhancement and protection of the local ecosystem.

Integrated Pest Management (IPM):

A method of controlling pests by prevention, monitoring, and control. This method of pest control offers the opportunity to eliminate or drastically reduce the use of pesticides, and to minimise the toxicity of and exposure to any products which are used.

Suitably Qualified Ecologist:

An individual achieving all the following items can be considered to be "suitably qualified" for the purposes of a BREEAM In-Use International assessment:

- Holds a degree or equivalent qualification in ecology or in a related subject comprising a significant ecology component.
- Is a practising ecologist, with a minimum of three years relevant experience (within the last five years). Such experience must clearly demonstrate a practical understanding of factors affecting ecology in relation to construction and the built environment; including, acting in an advisory capacity to provide recommendations for ecological protection, enhancement and mitigation measures. The relevant experience must relate to the country that the assessment is being carried out in.

Additional information

Other information

Convention on Biological Diversity – For more information regarding this please visit the official website: <http://www.cbd.int/convention/>



Management Performance: Pollution



Summary

The pollution category addresses the prevention and control of pollution and surface water run-off associated with an asset location and use. This facilitates a reduction in impact on surrounding communities and environment, arising from flooding and emissions to air, land and water.

Pollution source reduction is a proactive, and ultimately more cost effective and desirable, process than focusing on pollution treatment and disposal. It reduces the financial, societal and environmental costs from building operations. In addition to reducing the risk of significant financial and reputational implications in the event of a pollution incident, addressing pollution can help address the inequities that are currently present in our communities and provide a healthy environment for all demographic and economic groups, including those that are less advantaged or part of a vulnerable population.

Context

The United Nations have made 'good health and wellbeing' one of their SDGs, with an aim to 'substantially reduce the number of deaths and illnesses from hazardous chemicals and air, water and soil pollution and contamination' by 2030.

Light Pollution

The external lighting used by buildings can have a detrimental impact on the use and enjoyment of neighbouring properties, and on the mental and physical wellbeing of individuals in them. It also has a significant and often detrimental impact on local wildlife.

Refrigerants

The typical refrigerants used in building cooling systems are major greenhouse gases that are many times more potent than carbon dioxide in their contribution to global warming and climate change. Although, released in much smaller quantities they are, nevertheless, a significant contributor to increasing global temperatures. As such, they are the focus of increasingly strict regulatory controls internationally. Worldwide agreements (such as the 1992 United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC)) and its extension, the Kyoto Protocol, commits signatories to reducing greenhouse gas emissions and banning the most damaging gases. The agreements seek to shift use to low impact refrigerants over time and so provide a timescale for the phasing out of more potent refrigerants. Because the use of the gases is so prolific actions taken to limit their use are vital.

BREEAM supports this agenda and stimulates a more rapid change market transformation by creating market value for assets with reduced impact refrigerants by limiting the volume or weight of gases used, their potential impact, and for specifying systems which detect and control leakage of gas to the atmosphere.

Refrigerant leaks impact both the environment and financial performance of an asset, increasing the running time of the equipment and potentially damaging components of the system. Whilst many countries have regulatory systems in place that require leak testing and repair for systems of a certain size during regular

maintenance, knowing as soon as possible when a leak has developed is key to minimising the environmental impacts, managing operating costs and maximising the life cycle of the installed equipment.